way is also a consequence of the landscape and historical structuring in which the speech act happens. So, for example, it can hardly be denied that perceptions of Ashoka's guilt and repentance will have differed in Orissa, where the Kalinga war was fought, from perceptions of these at Erragudi and Girnar.

To continue with this theme of local interpretive difference, we could look at Sannathi in Karnataka, where the message was inscribed on a free-standing slab (or slabs) which bore edicts on both sides.[21] From what has survived, it is clear that two of the edicts inscribed here had earlier been found only at Dhauli and Jaugada in Orissa. So, whereas before the Sannathi discovery it was believed that this part of Ashoka's long rescript was meant for Kalinga alone, it is now evident that they were also intended for other places. The designations they bear, though, are the same as those in Orissa and are alluded to as Separate Rock Edicts 1 and 2. As in Orissa, the Kalinga Edict is omitted here, but unlike in Orissa the emperor's magnificent statement on tolerance in Rock Edict 12 is included. Among the other edicts, what has survived at Sannathi are Rock Edicts 12 and 14. The absence of the Kalinga Edict, the thirteenth in this anthology, means that it was deliberately dropped.

What explains the absence of Ashoka's account of Kalinga in Karnataka? During the late second and early third century BCE a part of the Bhima river valley, or 'greater Sannathi' as its excavators have called it, was marked by a strong Mauryan presence.[22] This was of an entirely different order from the preceding cultures at Sannathi. Habitation here goes back to the time of specialized hunter-gatherers who used microliths of all kinds. Their material equipment will have included other sorts of objects that have not survived. The site was then abandoned and later occupied by a black and red ware culture. This was an iron-using society and its pottery was of the kind usually associated with megaliths in Karnataka and beyond. The Mauryan occupation here overlay this horizon. With the advent of the